

WENDY CHEN

Senior Software Engineer / Technical Director

CONTACT / REEL

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Demo Reel (Fall 2025): <https://vimeo.com/1139509074> (password: doremi123)

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SUMMARY

Senior Software Engineer and Technical Director with 9+ years at Pixar Animation Studios bridging graphics engineering and feature animation production. Experienced building USD/Hydra-based tools, shading workflows, and artist-facing applications.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Pixar

Global Technology Technical Director | Emeryville, CA | August 2026 – Present

- Current production assignment on 'Incredibles 3'. Additional details available upon request.

Senior Software Engineer, Shading | Emeryville, CA | July 2017 – July 2026

- Led design and development of Leonardo, a procedural shading system built on USD/Hydra with Houdini frontend that enables artists to author procedural shading independently of generated input signals.
- Led design and development of material editing workflows in Hydra for new in-house lighting tool Luna in Presto.
- Developed shading workflows for in-house tool Flow. Support shading pipeline and character/sets workflows in Flow, Mari, and Katana.

Character Shading Technical Director (*Inside Out 2*) | Emeryville, CA | September 2022 – June 2023

- Developed procedural particle shading techniques in Houdini and Flow for Anger's signature crystalline "sugar particle" appearance.
 - Built skin shading networks and texture workflows for hero human characters using Mari, Flow, and Katana.
 - Provided production technical support through debugging, Python automation, documentation, and pipeline tooling.
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Blue Sky Studios

Production Engineering Intern | Greenwich, CT | June 2016 – August 2016

- Developed internal pipeline tools including web applications and Maya plugins supporting production workflows.
 - Built a geometry reduction prototype for Maya demonstrating automated optimization techniques.
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Walt Disney Animation Studios

Art & Production Intern | Burbank, CA | June 2015 – August 2015

- Look development for hero assets on the intern short film *Brew* using Disney's feature animation production pipeline.
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EDUCATION

YALE UNIVERSITY – B.S. Computer Science

New Haven, CT | 2013 - 2017

- 3.73 GPA. Coursework: Systems Programming, Parallel Programming, Operating Systems, Distributed Systems, Computer Graphics, Algorithms, Data Structures, Linear Algebra, Multivariable Calculus
 - Teaching Assistant: Parallel Programming (Spring '17), Computer Graphics Freshman Seminar (Spring '16)
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SKILLS / EXPERTISE

Graphics • USD • Hydra • C++ • Python • Flow • Presto • Luna • Houdini • Katana • Mari • Maya • Photoshop • Procreate